Types of Ocean Transport

Ocean transport may be divided into two broad categories.

a) Coastal shipping

Coastal shipping constitutes an important means of transport in all countries having a long coastline. It is a cheap means of transport for the movement of bulky cargoes like coal, iron ore etc. to domestic ports of country. Usually, coastal shipping trade of a country is reserved for national shipping. In India, Coastal shipping trade is now exclusively reserved for Indian ships.





b) Overseas shipping

It means the passengers' and goods have to cross ocean. Example India export goods to America.

Ocean going ships may also be divided into two, namely Liners and Tramps:

(i) Liner

An ocean liner is a passenger ship primarily used as a form of transportation across seas or oceans. Liners may also carry cargo or mail, and may sometimes be used for other purposes (e.g., for pleasure cruises or as hospitals ship). They sail to schedule, whether they have a full load or not. They follow defined routes with fixed places and times of call. Regularity of service, god sped and luxurious facilities to passengers are the specialties of liners.

There are two types of liners, namely, Passenger liners and Cargo liners.

(ii) Tramps

Tramps are essentially cargo vessels. See the picture above. They have no set routes. They do not follow any timetable. They sail only when they get sufficient load. They sail at any time and carry cargoes for almost any ports.



International shipping Vs Overseas shipping

International shipping can be between countries that are connected by land. For Example, Foreign trade between India and Bangladesh. Overseas shipping means the package has to cross ocean. For Example, International trade between India and South Africa.

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